

WASTE → VALUE



CleanCredit

Plastic credits

Plastic credits monetize Bangladesh waste recovery while paying informal pickers fairly



THE SITUATION IN BANGLADESH

Bangladesh consumed roughly 977,000 tonnes of plastic in 2020, yet only about 31% was recycled, and a World Bank-funded survey found 30,000 tonnes of plastic waste choking the four rivers around Dhaka, half of it in the Buriganga ¹. The country now ranks among the top ten contributors to global marine plastic pollution, with an estimated 25,000 tonnes entering the ocean each year ⁶, part of a wider pattern in which more than 1,000 rivers carry roughly 80% of the world's riverine plastic to the sea ⁷. The people closest to this problem are Dhaka's informal waste pickers, who already reclaim around 475 tonnes of recyclables a day but mostly earn just US\$40–75 a month for 8–10 hour shifts, without recognition or protection ². Bangladesh's recoverable plastic-waste value could grow into an estimated US\$365 million-a-year market, and 2025 rules introduced Extended Producer Responsibility and plastic-credit mechanisms to mobilize it ⁴.

OUR PITCH

CleanCredit collects and recycles plastic waste, pays waste-pickers fairly, and sells the outcome twice: as verified plastic credits and as recovered recyclables ⁴. Each tonne recovered can be certified under Verra's Plastic Waste Reduction Standard, the kind of credit brands such as Mars, Clarins and Caudalie buy at initial estimated prices of US\$200–800 per tonne beyond a baseline ³. That demand sits inside a global plastic-credit market valued at about US\$462 million in 2024 and projected toward roughly US\$1.79 billion by 2031 at about 23.6% CAGR, giving early Bangladesh supply a credible and growing buyer base ⁵. Our wedge is the existing informal network — 6,000-plus recycling enterprises and 300-plus plants already sort post-consumer plastic — which we formalize and fairly compensate rather than replace, turning today's sub-US\$75-a-month pickers into traceable, paid suppliers ²⁴. It works because Bangladesh's new EPR and plastic-credit policy aligns producer obligations with the same tonnes we recover, letting one verified collection serve regulatory compliance, brand credits, and the recyclables market at once ⁸.

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